

Headphones with mic



Calling and vibing all the time!

Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in

Ever since the COVID-19 pandemic, there has been a substantial shift in the usage patterns of individuals who work and study from home. The microphone is now an integral aspect in the buying decision of users when it comes to purchasing headphones, and for good reason. A good microphone can be the difference between a bad-quality call filled with disturbances and a good-quality one with a clear and distinct voice with minimal distractions. Headphone manufacturers are increasingly using a combination of good beamforming or boom mics mixed with AI algorithms that enhance the user's voice and mitigate background noise. We've included both over-ear headphones and TWS earphones in our suggestions, so you get plenty of options to choose from.



of ambient noise. In our testing, we found that the Jabra Elite 85H can confidently block out most ambient chatter, including difficult-to-isolate sounds such as other people talking in the background. All this while still providing crystal clear sound in calls irrespective of platform.



Poly Voyager Focus 2 UC

The Poly (previously Plantronics) Voyager Focus 2 UC is a headset advertised for those whose day revolves around taking calls on Zoom, Teams, Meet, and the works. It is one of the few headphones on this

list with a boom microphone. The advantage of boom microphones is that it is situated closer to your mouth which inadvertently improves voice clarity in general. It features Poly's Acoustic Fence technology which basically works behind the scene to mitigate background chatter and wind noise as much as possible to allow for clearer calls. While we haven't reviewed these headphones, general consensus says that these are also incredibly comfortable, allowing users to take long work calls without too much fatigue.



Bose NC 700

The Bose NC 700 is one of our top choices for the best headphones with microphones. Why, you ask? Bose's beamforming microphones work perfectly with its 'rejection array' algorithm to isolate speech and mitigate unwanted background

noise. The headphones consist of eight microphones in total and they divide the call and ANC duties between them. Six microphones work together to cancel background noise while four of these further suppress the remaining sound to allow for precise voice pick-up. As a result, calls are clear



Sony WH-1000XM5

The Sony WH-1000XM5 pretty much sits at the pinnacle of everything that's considered important in a good pair of headphones. So, naturally, the microphone quality is fantastic. Equipped with eight microphones and a noise rejection

algorithm powered by AI, the Sony WH-1000XM5's call quality is just impeccable. Background noise is mitigated to a great degree and the caller's voice sounds distinct and clear whether indoors or outdoors. The headphones' microphone is massively improved over its predecessor as well, sporting better background noise rejection and more clear voice pick-up.

Jabra Elite 85H

Given that Jabra has solidified its name in having some of the best microphones for headphones, it isn't surprising that a Jabra product sits near the top of this list. The Jabra Elite 85H employs eight microphones in the headphones, six of which are used predominantly to enhance the quality of calls while blocking out distractions in the form